



AWS Cost Explorer - Step-by-Step Walkthrough



Step 1: Sign in to the AWS Management Console

- Go to: <https://console.aws.amazon.com/>
 - Sign in with an account that has **Billing and Cost Management** access.
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Step 2: Navigate to Cost Explorer

1. In the AWS Console, search for “**Billing**” in the search bar.
2. Click **Billing**.
3. In the left-hand menu, select **Cost Explorer**.
4. Click “**Launch Cost Explorer**”.

If it's your first time, click “**Enable Cost Explorer**”. It may take a few minutes to process.



Step 3: Choose a Time Range

- At the top of the screen, set a **time range** (e.g., “Last 3 months”).
 - You can choose a custom date range using the calendar option.
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Step 4: Set Granularity

- Choose between:
 - **Daily**
 - **Monthly**
 - **Hourly (for some reports)**

Example: Select **Monthly** to get a high-level overview of your spend.

✓ **Step 5: Group Your Data**

In the **Group By** dropdown:

- Choose how to group the data:
 - **Service** – (e.g., EC2, S3)
 - **Linked account** – if you're using AWS Organizations
 - **Usage type** – (e.g., data transfer, storage)
 - **Region**
 - **Tag** – (if you've enabled cost allocation tags)

Example: Group by **Service** to see which AWS services are costing the most.

✓ **Step 6: Apply Filters (Optional)**

Use the **Filters** panel on the left to narrow your view:

- By **Service**
- By **Region**
- By **Linked Account**

- By **Tag**
- By **Usage Type**

Example: Filter by **Service: Amazon EC2** to only view EC2-related costs.

✓ **Step 7: View and Analyze the Report**

- The **graph** shows spending trends.
 - Below the graph, the **table** breaks down cost/usage per group.
 - Hover over bars or lines in the graph to see exact cost figures.
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✓ **Step 8: Save the Report**

1. Click the “**Save As**” button in the top-right.
2. Name your report (e.g., “EC2 Monthly Spend”).
3. The report is now saved for future access.

You can also schedule reports to be **emailed** regularly.

✓ **Step 9: Use Forecasting (Optional)**

1. In the left-hand menu, click **Forecast**.
 2. Choose a **service or all services**.
 3. Select a **future date range**.
 4. View the predicted spend based on historical usage.
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✓ Step 10: Export Your Report (Optional)

- Click “**Export**” (top-right).
 - Choose **CSV** to download the data.
 - Use this for sharing or integrating with external tools (Excel, BI dashboards, etc.).
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🎯 Final Tips

- Use **Cost Allocation Tags** for detailed breakdowns (enable them under **Billing** → **Cost Allocation Tags**).
 - Combine Cost Explorer with **AWS Budgets** to set alerts for spend limits.
 - Explore **Cost Anomaly Detection** to get notified of unusual spikes.
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